Fatigue & Mental Wellbeing Policy

For
R S Services (Yorkshire) Ltd

This policy supplements the Health & Safety policy statement. Any employee must not commence or continue work if they are fatigued to such an extent that their condition may prejudice their safety, or the safety of others.

Managers will not plan work arrangements for personnel who are fatigued or are likely to become fatigued during the work period. Managers and supervisors are authorised to prevent any employee from commencing work or continuing to work if they believe the person is fatigued. To contribute to improved safety performance through the control of fatigue limitations on hours worked will be applied. Employees must:

- Not work more than twelve hours in any one shift.
- Not work more than 72 hours in a calendar week.
- Have a minimum rest period of 12 hours between booking off and booking on for consecutive shifts.
- Not work more than 13 shifts within any 14 consecutive days. Calculating the total hours and shifts worked must include the hours worked for another supplier and on all infrastructures.

Recording and monitoring will take place weekly using the working hours data. Exceedance of these hours in emergency situations shall only be permitted once the risk of fatigue has been assessed and an acceptable outcome achieved. The implementation of this policy is the responsibility of the Health & Safety Manager.

Mental wellbeing in the workplace is relevant to all employees and everyone can contribute to improved mental wellbeing at work.

Addressing workplace mental wellbeing can help strengthen the positive, protective factors of employment, reduce risk factors for mental ill health and improve general health. It can also help promote the employment of people who have experienced mental health problems, and support them once they are at work.

Important aspects of mental health and wellbeing includes providing information and raising awareness, management skills to deal with issues around mental health and stress effectively, providing a supportive work environment, offering assistance, advice and support to anyone experiencing a mental health problem or returning to work after a period of absence due to mental health problems.

The aim of the Mental Wellbeing Policy is to create a workplace environment that promotes and supports the mental wellbeing of all employees and to ensure that the working environment promotes the mental health and wellbeing of employees, clients and visitors.

Objectives

To develop a supportive culture, address factors that may negatively affect mental wellbeing, and to develop management skills.

Policy actions:-

- Reduce discrimination and stigma by increasing awareness and understanding.
- Give employees information on and increase their awareness of mental wellbeing.
- Give non-judgemental and proactive support to individual staff that experience mental health problems.
- Include information about this mental health policy in the staff induction programme.

- Provide opportunities for employees to look after their mental wellbeing, for example through physical activity, stress reducing activities and social events.
- Set employees realistic targets that do not require them to work unreasonable hours.
- Ensure all staff have clearly defined job descriptions, objectives and responsibilities and provide them with good management support, appropriate training and adequate resources to do their job.
- Manage conflict effectively and ensure the workplace is free from bullying and harassment, discrimination and racism.
- Establish good two-way communication to ensure staff involvement, particularly during periods of organisational change.

To provide support for employees experiencing mental health difficulties – Policy Actions: -

- Ensure individuals suffering from mental health problems are treated fairly and consistently.
- Clearly communicate colleagues who are able to support at initial symptoms of stress to prevent further stress.
- Make every effort to identify suitable alternative employment, in consultation with the employee, where a return to the same job is not possible due to identified risks or other factors.
- Treat all matters relating to individual employees and their mental health problems in the strictest confidence and share on a 'need to know' basis only with consent from the individual concerned.

To encourage the employment of people who have experienced mental health problems – Policy Actions: -

- Show a positive and enabling attitude to employees and job applicants with mental health issues.
- Ensure that all staff involved in recruitment and selection are briefed on mental health issues and the Disability Discrimination Act, and are trained in appropriate interview skills.
- Do not make assumptions that a person with a mental health problem will be more vulnerable to workplace stress or take more time off than any other employee or job applicant.
- Ensure all line managers have information and training about managing mental health in the workplace.

To recognise that workplace stress is a health and safety issue. Policy actions: -

- Identify all workplace stressors and conduct risk assessments to eliminate stress or control the risks from stress.
- Consult with trade union safety representatives on all proposed action relating to the prevention of workplace stress.
- Provide training in good management practices.
- Provide confidential counselling and adequate resources.
- Align with other relevant policies such as physical activity, alcohol and absence management.

Review and monitoring

The policy will be reviewed annually to ensure that it remains relevant or sooner should feedback identify additional measures to implement.

The person with overall responsibility for implementing this Policy is: Shaun Best - Director

Signature:
Shaun Best - Director

Date: April 2026